

Lauren A. Glevanik

Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology
University of California, Los Angeles
Los Angeles, CA 90095
lglevanik@ucla.edu • lglevanik.github.io

EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles Sept 2022 – Present

Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology
Dissertation: *Community consequences of seed dispersal in a California annual grassland*
Advisor: Dr. Nathan Kraft

University of California, Davis Sept 2016 – June 2020

B.S. Plant Biology
Minors: Professional Writing; Ecology, Evolution & Biodiversity

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Researcher, University of California, Los Angeles Sept 2022 – Present

Investigate community consequences of species-specific seed dispersal in a California annual grassland. Quantify dispersal across a diverse plant community, evaluate mechanistic approaches for estimating and modeling dispersal, and explore how feedbacks between local environmental conditions, plant performance, and dispersal influence species coexistence and community dynamics.
PI: Dr. Nathan Kraft, Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology

Tomato Breeding Program Aide, HM.CLAUSE June 2020 – June 2022

Evaluated and selected tomato hybrid and parent lines in the field for advancement to production. Managed field data collection and evaluated performance for 800+ varieties across four off-station trials. Investigated the effects of epigenetic yield enhancement in processing tomato; designed experimental trial, collected data, and analyzed data in collaboration with EpiCrop Technologies (Lincoln, NE).

Vernal Pool Field Technician, University of Colorado Boulder Dec 2019 – Mar 2021

Investigated evolutionary feedbacks between dispersal and variable environmental conditions in vernal pools at Jepson Prairie Preserve. Planted *Lasthenia* populations, implemented neighbor removal treatments, and censused seedling germination.
PI: Dr. Nancy Emery, Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology

Undergraduate Researcher, University of California, Davis Jan 2017 – June 2018

Investigated genetic controls of tomato leaf morphology and their subsequent effects on fruit sugar content. Conducted molecular and phenotypic analysis protocols including DNA extractions, PCR, electrophoresis, tissue collection, microscope slide preparation.
PI: Dr. Neelima Sinha, Department of Plant Biology

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Presentations

- LA Glevanik.** 2026. "Modeling performance-dispersal feedbacks in a serpentine annual plant community." Invited speaker. California Native Plant Society Channel Islands Chapter Meeting.
- LA Glevanik.** 2025. "Trait plasticity alters seed dispersal potential in an annual California grassland community." Invited speaker. California Native Grassland Association GRASS Speaker Series.
- LA Glevanik.** 2025. "Species-specific seed dispersal in an annual plant community." Invited speaker. California Native Plant Society LA/SMM Chapter Meeting.

Contributed Presentations

- LA Glevanik, NJB Kraft.** 2026. "Plant performance modulates seed dispersal in an annual grassland community." Contributed oral presentation. Ecological Society of America Annual Meeting, Salt Lake City, UT.
- LA Glevanik, NJB Kraft.** 2026. "Community consequences of seed dispersal in an annual grassland." Contributed oral presentation. UCLA Ecology and Evolutionary Biology Research Symposium, Los Angeles, CA.
- LA Glevanik, J Austria,* L Anderson,* N Kamps,* NJB Kraft.** 2025. "Rainfall influences seed persistence in an annual grassland community." Contributed oral presentation. AMEBA x Biological Sciences Council Research Showcase. Awarded audience choice best presentation.
- LA Glevanik, NJB Kraft.** 2025. "Community consequences of stress-induced seed dispersal shifts in an annual grassland." Contributed oral presentation. Better Grasslands Through Knowledge: A Science-Based CNGA Symposium, Hopland, CA.
- LA Glevanik, NJB Kraft.** 2024. "Quantifying species-specific seed dispersal in annual grassland communities." Contributed oral presentation. Ecological Society of America Annual Meeting, Long Beach CA.

AWARDS & GRANTS

California Native Plant Society Workshop Scholarship, \$1450	2026
California Native Plant Society LA/SMM Conference Grant, \$500	2026
UCLA Ecology and Evolutionary Biology Academic Quarter Fellowship, \$9000	2025
California Native Plant Society Channel Islands Chapter Grant, \$1500	2025
La Kretz Center + Stunt Ranch Research Grant, \$1500	2024
UCLA Ecology and Evolutionary Biology Departmental Research Grant, \$2000	2024
UCLA Ecology and Evolutionary Biology Departmental Conference Grant, \$910	2024
California Native Plant Society LA/SMM Chapter Grant, \$1500	2024
California Native Grasslands Association GRASS Grant, \$500	2024
UCLA Ecology and Evolutionary Biology Departmental Fellowship \$15000	2022-2023
UC Davis College of Biological Sciences Dean's Honors List	2020
Oliver Leonard Botany Scholarship \$1500	2019
Liliane D. Wells Botany Scholarship \$400	2016
UC Davis Cal Aggie Alumni Association Leadership Award \$1500	2016

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of California, Los Angeles

- 2026 Teaching Fellow, EEB 187: Advances in Animal Ecology and Evolution
- 2025 Teaching Fellow, EEB 100L: Introduction to Ecology & Behavior Laboratory
- 2025 Teaching Associate, EEB 162: Plant Physiology
- 2025 Teaching Associate, ENV 150: Environmental Journalism, Science Communication, & New Media
- 2024 Teaching Associate, EEB 161: Plant Ecology
- 2024 Teaching Assistant, EEB 100: Introduction to Ecology & Behavior
- 2023 Teaching Assistant, EEB 161: Plant Ecology
- 2023 Teaching Assistant, EEB 100: Introduction to Ecology & Behavior

University of California, Davis

- 2018 Student Teaching Assistant, EDU 198: Foundations for University Success
- 2017 First-Year Aggie Connections Mentor, BIS 5: Exploring Biological Sciences

MENTORING

- UCLA Undergraduate Research Mentees Jan 2023 – Present
 - Noah Kamps (2025)
 - Jalen Austria (2025)
 - Lily Anderson (2024-2025; *awarded Dean's Prize for Excellence in Science*)
 - Genelle Marcelino-Searles (2024-2025)
 - Aaron Wu (2024-2025; *Honorable Mention Donald J. Buth Outstanding Poster Award*)
 - Maddie McEwen (2023-2024) (*3rd place Donald J. Buth Outstanding Poster Award*)
 - Hannah Gray (2023-2024) (*3rd place Donald J. Buth Outstanding Poster Award*)
- UCLA EEB Graduate Peer Mentorship Program (3 mentees) Sept 2023 – Present
- Peer Mentor, UC Davis BioLaunch Sept 2018 – June 2020

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

Education

Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching, and Learning (CIRTL) @ UCLA

- CIRTL Practitioner Certification (2026)
- Implementing and Communicating a Teaching-as-Research Project (2026)
- Developing a Teaching-as-Research Project (2026)
- Research as High Impact Practice in STEM Education (2025)
- Advanced Learning Through Evidence-Based STEM Teaching (2025)
- CIRTL Associate Certification (2025)
- Introduction to Evidence-Based Undergraduate STEM Teaching (2024)

Research Mentorship Training (Center for the Improvement of Mentored Experiences in Research (CIMER))

Participated in 15 hours of evidence-based training in effective and culturally responsive research mentorship developed by NRMN and CIMER. Enacted a Mentoring Action Plan to enhance mentoring practices and develop a mentoring philosophy. (2024)

Scientific

California Native Plant Society

CNPS Vernal Pool Plant Taxonomy Workshop (2026)

CNPS Rare Plant Treasure Hunt and Vegetation Sampling (2022)

California Naturalist Certification

UC Agriculture and Natural Resources Division (2019)

Capstone: *Lake Tahoe Water Quality Analysis using Snapshot Day Citizen Science Data*

Faculty Advisor: Dr. Laci Gerhart-Barley, UC Davis Department of Evolution and Ecology

OUTREACH & SERVICE

UCLA EEB Research Symposium Poster Judge	June 2026
Exploring Your Universe @ UCLA K-12 Science Fair	
Event Volunteer	Nov 2022, 2025
Ecology Booth Coordinator	Nov 2023, 2024
Classroom Scientist Mentor, Planting Science	Mar 2024 – Present
Docent, Jepson Prairie Preserve, Solano Land Trust	Nov 2019 – Present
UC ANR California Naturalist Program	Mar 2019 – Present
Contributing Writer & Editor, Envirobites Blog	Dec 2023 – Sept 2025
Founder & President, Plant Biology Club at UC Davis	Sept 2017 – June 2019
Classroom Science Instructor, SproutUp at UC Davis	Jan 2018 – May 2018

SCIENCE WRITING

Reports (non-peer-reviewed)

LA Glevanik. 2020. "Breeding for Improved Fruit Quality and Flavor in Tomato." Grey literature for internal use at HM.CLAUSE.

LA Glevanik. 2020. "Population sex ratio of coyote brush (*Baccharis pilularis*) in Stebbins Cold Canyon Reserve." *UC Davis Prized Writing*, 31: 162-168.

Selected Media Articles

LA Glevanik. 2025. [Antarctica's geography reveals its ancient origins and hints toward the continent's future.](#) *Envirobites*.

LA Glevanik. 2025. [Island-dwelling iguanas first arrived in Fiji by rafting across 5000 miles of open ocean.](#) *Envirobites*.

LA Glevanik. 2024. [Birds of a feather flock to bad weather: Study reveals how seabirds chase cyclones.](#) *Envirobites*.

LA Glevanik. 2024. [Hive minds: Bumblebees collaborate to learn complex behaviors.](#) *Envirobites*.

LA Glevanik. 2024. [These bat teeth were made for chompin': An evolutionary history of bat teeth.](#) *Envirobites*.

LA Glevanik. 2020. [An alien invasion threatens wildflower habitat.](#) *Student Conservation Corner*. UC Davis Department of Wildlife, Fish, and Conservation Biology.

LA Glevanik. 2020. [Orchid bees mix unique perfumes to signal potential mates.](#) *The California Aggie*, 138(14): 13.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Ecological Society of America (ESA)
California Native Plant Society (CNPS)
California Native Grasslands Association (CNGA)